a closer look at Pixie, as it can be a very useful tool in your tool belt. Now, let's move on to a distributed tracing veteran open source frontend.

6.2.3 Zipkin

Zipkin (https://zipkin.io/) is an open source distributed tracing system, written in Java and run by the OpenZipkin volunteer organization. Zipkin has a tracing-focused UI (see figure 6.8) and integrates a range of backends, including ES/OS, Apache Cassandra, and MySQL, with other backends offered as third-party extensions. The Zipkin project was also inspired by Google Dapper and originally created by Twitter, with roots going back to 2015.

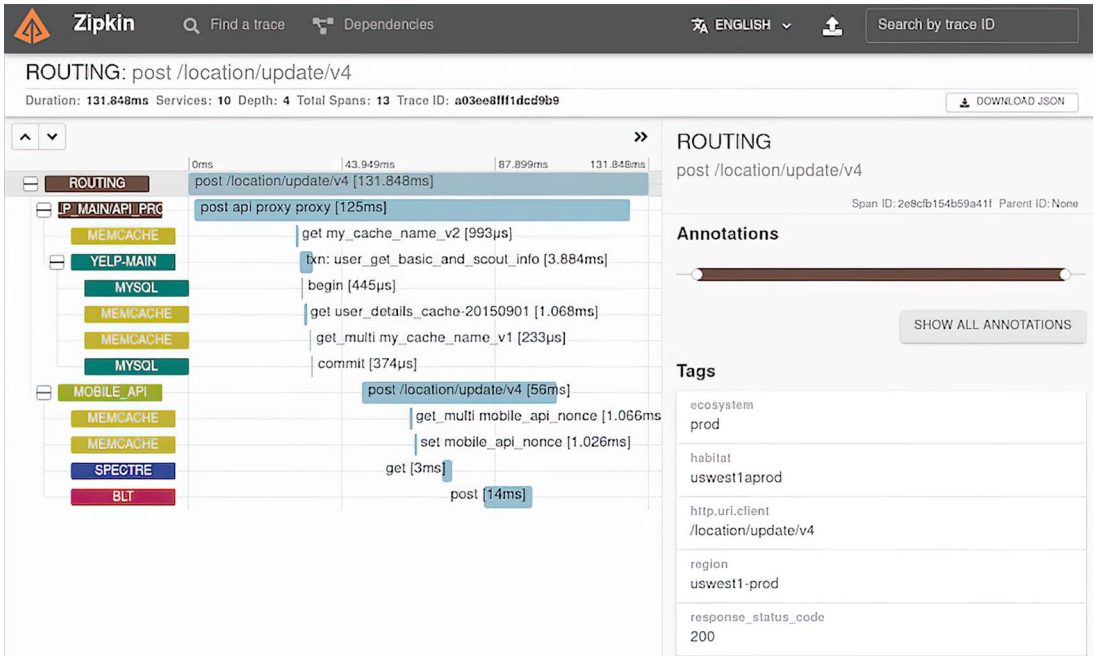


Figure 6.8 A screenshot of Zipkin in action (from the project docs)

I won't go into any detail here concerning Zipkin's architecture, since it is very similar to what we've seen in the context of CNCF Jaeger. If you want to try out Zipkin and see it in action, check out the Zipkin GitHub repo, which has a nice collection of Docker Compose examples (http://mng.bz/wv7P) from using Apache Cassandra as a backend to trace ingestion with Apache Kafka, readily available for you. To view the Docker Compose example, do a `docker-compose up` in the respective directory and then go to http://localhost:9411 and click Run Query to see the results. Next up, we'll cover an exciting Apache Software Foundation (ASF) project.